COUNTRY REPORTS: KENYA

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Standards · Public debate and participation in policymaking

Strategies, plans and policies

INVESTOR CONFIDENCE IN THE DIGITAL INVESTMENT CLIMATE

- **US tech giants flag Kenya investment risks** — Daily Nation, 10 September 2026

  Executives from four large United States technology and payments companies told a Nairobi business summit that unpredictable taxes, regulations and approvals could deter new capital from Kenya. They said investors need policy certainty to commit and expand, a warning aimed at the country's bid to be East Africa's digital investment hub.

NATIONAL COMMUNICATION POLICY: ENHANCING TRUST IN GOVERNMENT

- **One Government, One Voice: Isaboke on Kenya's new communication revolution** — The Star, 14 September 2026

  Kenya's broadcasting and telecoms principal secretary, Stephen Isaboke, said a new National Communication Policy creates a National Communication Centre to validate and release state information, and ties ministries' communication plans to performance contracts. He called his department's KES 6.4 billion 2026 allocation inadequate and said digitised government services rose from 353 in 2022 to more than 21,500.

- **Gov't to tackle misinformation through coordinated communication as PS Isaboke unveils new measures to rebuild public trust - TV47 Digital** — TV47 Digital, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's broadcasting principal secretary Stephen Isaboke directed all ministries, departments and agencies to build communication into their programmes under the National Communication Policy 2026, at a forum opened on 15 September 2026. The National Communication Centre is being strengthened as the government's information repository, using AI tools for public sentiment analysis.

NATIONAL PAYMENT SYSTEM POLICY (DRAFT, AUGUST 2026)

- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's National Treasury and central bank published a draft National Payment System Policy and a draft National Payment System Bill, 2026 for public comment on 21 September 2026. The bill would replace the current Act and license payment providers and system operators by category, with minimum capital of Ksh5

million to Ksh250 million. It also requires interoperability, allows open-finance data sharing with consent and brings virtual asset providers that offer payments under the law, while the policy commits the government to a national instant payment switch.

- **Draft National Payment System Policy, August 2026** — The National Treasury, Republic of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's draft National Payment System Policy, dated August 2026, which identifies ten gaps in the current system. It commits to a national instant payment switch, requires open APIs and gives non-banks access to settlement. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release.

ACCESS TO INFORMATION POLICY

- **State vows proactive disclosure as Kenya marks access to information day** — The Star (Kenya), 27 September 2026

  Kenya's Broadcasting and Telecommunications Principal Secretary, Steve Isaboke, said on 24 September 2026 that the government will publish information before citizens have to request it, and that with a newly approved Access to Information Policy the focus now shifts to implementing the 2016 Act. He spoke at a forum hosted by the Finnish embassy with UNESCO and the Commission on Administrative Justice.

- **CS Kabogo gazettes new policy to boost public access to government information** — People Daily, 13 October 2026

  Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary gazetted the Access to Information Policy, 2026 on 9 October. It requires public offices to disclose key records proactively, answer requests within set timelines and give written reasons for refusals.

- **Kenya Has a New Law-Backed Plan to Force Public Offices to Release Records. Will It Work?** — Dawan Africa, 13 October 2026

  An explainer on Kenya's newly gazetted Access to Information Policy asks whether it will change practice: citizens already hold a right to request records, it notes, but often do not get them.

NATIONAL AI POLICY FOR SCIENCE, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION

- **Invitation for Public Participation in the Review of the Draft National AI Policy for Science, Research and Innovation and the Draft Science Diplomacy Policy** — State Department for Science, Research and Innovation (Kenya), 1 October 2026

  Kenya's State Department for Science, Research and Innovation invited public comment on a draft National AI Policy for Science, Research and Innovation and a draft Science Diplomacy Policy, with a deadline of 14 October 2026. The drafts are posted on the department's website. The notice is undated.

Legislation and regulation

ACCESSION TO THE BUDAPEST CONVENTION ON CYBERCRIME

- **Accession to the Budapest Convention** — KICTANet, 1 September 2026

  Kenya plans to accede to the Council of Europe's Budapest Convention on Cybercrime, and Parliament is inviting public views by 11 September 2026, according to a 1 September post to the KICTANet mailing list by lawyer Victor Kapiyo. The parliamentary notice itself is not quoted.

KENYA INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS REGULATIONS 2026

- **Register now: Validation forum on Kenya's draft ICT regulations (Sep 15–17)** — KICTANet, 1 September 2026

Kenya's Ministry of Information, Communications and the Digital Economy is holding a virtual validation forum on 15 draft Kenya Information and Communication Regulations, 2026, from 15 to 17 September. The drafts cover licensing, broadcasting, spectrum, tariffs, interconnection, consumer protection, domain names and the Universal Service Fund. Registration is required.

- **Ministry of ICT Hosts Stakeholder Workshop to Validate Proposed Kenya Information and Communications Regulations** — Uasin Gishu News, 23 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT ministry and the Communications Authority held a three-day workshop to validate proposed Kenya Information and Communications Regulations, reported on 23 September 2026. The review covers licensing, spectrum, numbering, interconnection, tariffs, consumer protection, universal service, infrastructure sharing, electronic certification and domain names under the 1998 Act.

STANDALONE DATA-CENTRE LICENCE CATEGORY

- **Proposed Licensing Framework for Data Centres (Consultation Version)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 1 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya published a consultation in September 2026 proposing a standalone licence for co-location data centres, which are now licensed as Tier 2 network facilities providers. Proposed fees are KSh5,000 to apply, KSh100,000 initially and KSh80,000 or 0.4% of gross turnover a year, for a 15-year term; existing NFP and ASP licensees would need no separate licence.

- **Kenya Proposes Standalone Licence Framework for Data Centres** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya has proposed a standalone Data Centre licence for co-location operators, taking them out of the Network Facilities Provider-Tier 2 category they currently sit under, and opened comment for thirty days from its public notice. The Authority gives visibility over data-centre operations, support for investment and proportionality with comparable jurisdictions as its reasons; the notice itself is not held, so the closing date is unestablished.

- **Kenya proposes introduction of standalone data center license** — Connecting Africa, 10 September 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator opened a 30-day public consultation on a standalone licence for colocation data centres. It says the proposal would give greater regulatory clarity, improve visibility of data-centre operations and support investment, and it follows a broader overhaul of the telecommunications market framework begun in 2025.

NNAI RESOURCES FRAMEWORK CA.F.530:2026

- **Inside new rules for short codes, network equipment and mobile numbers announced by CA** — Pulse Kenya, 8 September 2026

  Kenya's Communications Authority issued an enhanced framework for numbering, naming, addressing and identification resources and opened consultations on network equipment specifications and on deactivating and recycling inactive numbers. Short codes move to allocation on a services basis rather than per operator, and the same set of notices carries the Authority's separate proposal for a standalone data centre licence category.

TECHNOPOLIS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

- **Technopolis Development Authority Board fully constituted under new Act** — TechTrends Kenya, 14 September 2026

Kenya's Technopolis Development Authority board is now complete under the Technopolis Act 2026, in force since 29 May 2026, with the appointment of James Musee Nduna, Yvonne Teresia Ogwang and Yunis M. Omar. Ogwang is the Council of Governors' nominee.

NATIONAL PAYMENT SYSTEM BILL 2026

- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **The National Payment System Bill, 2026 (draft for comment)** — The National Treasury / Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  The full draft text of Kenya's National Payment System Bill, 2026, which runs to 79 clauses. It sets licence capital of Ksh5 million to Ksh250 million, requires interoperability, provides for open finance, brings virtual asset providers into scope and sets fines of up to Ksh20 million. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release.

- **Kenya: National Payment System Bill, 2026 proposes comprehensive overhaul of the payments regulatory framework** — Bowmans, 30 September 2026

  Law firm Bowmans summarises Kenya's draft National Payment System Bill, 2026, published by the National Treasury and Central Bank of Kenya with comments due by 9 October 2026. The bill would repeal the 2014 Act, create ten licence categories for payment providers and operators, allow foreign firms to apply and require banks to obtain separate central bank authorisation, with a one-year transition.

CENTRAL BANK OF KENYA (NON-DEPOSIT TAKING CREDIT PROVIDERS) REGULATIONS, 2026

- **The Central Bank of Kenya (Non-Deposit Taking Credit Providers) Regulations, 2026 (Legal Notice No. 191 of 2026)** — Kenya Gazette Supplement No. 234 (Kenya Law), 29 September 2026

  Kenya gazetted the Central Bank of Kenya (Non-Deposit Taking Credit Providers) Regulations, 2026 on 29 September, replacing the 2022 digital credit rules. Licensed lenders pay KSh 500,000 a year, need prior approval to change pricing, must obtain separate consent to process personal data and must have AI lending decisions reviewed by people. Unregulated lenders have six months to apply.

- **CBK raises compliance costs and tightens the rules governing Kenya's growing credit providers** — TechTrends KE, 5 October 2026

  The Central Bank of Kenya's final regulations for non-deposit-taking credit providers set a Sh100,000 licence application fee and annual fees of Sh500,000 for licensed and Sh250,000 for registered providers, against Sh5,000 and Sh20,000 under the earlier digital credit regime. A new Sh1 million penalty applies to annual fees unpaid by 31 December.

STATISTICS ACT 2006 (CAP. 112)

- **Senators push Bill to transform KNBS into Kenya Statistics Authority** — People Daily, 12 October 2026

  Kenya's Senate finance and budget committee reviewed the draft Statistics Bill 2026 with the national statistics bureau, KNBS, on 12 October 2026. The bill would turn KNBS into a Kenya Statistics Authority as sole producer of official statistics, require a statistics office in every county and set fines of up to KSh 5 million. Senators questioned the authority's independence.

Data protection

SAFEGUARDS FOR DEACTIVATING AND RECYCLING TELEPHONE NUMBERS

- **Procedures and technical safeguards for deactivation and recycling of inactive telecommunication numbering resources (CA.G.520:2026, Version 1.0)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 1 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya published draft guidelines (CA.G.520:2026) on deactivating and recycling inactive phone numbers, open for comment until 11 September 2026 with a proposed start date of 19 September. The draft sets up a central database of deactivated and recycled numbers, quarterly reporting by operators, a *106# status check, and whitelisting for prisoners and incapacitated subscribers.

- **Kenya's new phone number rules will make recycling costlier for telcos** — TechCabal, 2 September 2026

  Kenya's Communications Authority published draft procedures for deactivating and recycling mobile numbers: deactivation only after three consecutive months without revenue-generating activity, then three further months of contact attempts by message and the details given at registration, with at-risk numbers published in national media. The document is out for consultation, with memoranda due 11 September 2026.

- **SIM deactivation now backed by law, CA says** — Daily Nation, 7 October 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator told a National Assembly committee that SIM deactivation and number recycling now run under its 2026 procedures: notice to the subscriber's contact after three months' inactivity, a public notice and status check before recycling after six, and whitelisting for subscribers who are sick, imprisoned or deceased. It was answering a petition against the largest operator's recycling.

- **CA to set up central database to track recycled phone numbers** — Daily Nation, 12 October 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator said it will set up a central database of recycled phone numbers, which operators must update every three months. Banks, fintechs and bulk message senders would check it before sending account messages to a number.

HIGH COURT RULING ON RIDE-HAILING DATA RETENTION

- **What High Court Ruling on Uber, Bolt and Other Ride-Hailing Taxi Mean for Kenya's Consumers** — Consumers Federation of Kenya (COFEK), 2 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court struck down a National Transport and Safety Authority rule requiring ride-hailing platforms to retain passenger and driver data for three years and hand it over on demand, finding it breached the right to privacy and the Data Protection Act 2019, the Consumers Federation of Kenya reported on 2 September 2026. The court, on a petition by Bolt, also blocked an 18% commission cap and suspended its declaration for 12 months so the government can redo the regulations.

GUIDANCE NOTES FOR CROSS-BORDER DATA TRANSFERS

- **Guidance Notes for Cross-border Data Transfers** — Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (Kenya), 8 September 2026

  Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner published Guidance Notes for Cross-border Data Transfers in September 2026, with a foreword by Data Commissioner Immaculate Kassait. The 63-page document includes a compliance checklist, an application form for binding corporate rules and standard clauses for controller-to-controller and controller-to-processor transfers. It prints no issue date.

DRAFT NOTICE ON ADDITIONAL CATEGORIES OF SENSITIVE PERSONAL DATA

- **DRAFT Public Notice: Additional Categories of Sensitive Personal Data (Data Protection Act, 2019, s.47) — PDF** — Office of the Data Protection Commissioner, 11 September 2026

Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner published a draft notice on 11 September 2026 adding political affiliation and trade union membership to sensitive personal data under section 47 of the Data Protection Act 2019. It applies only to data transferred from countries whose law already treats them as sensitive. Public comment is invited; no deadline is stated.

MATEY V SAFARICOM RULING ON ACCESS TO DATA-DISCLOSURE RECORDS

- **Matey v Safaricom PLC (Constitutional Miscellaneous Application E043 of 2026) [2026] KEHC 13624 (KLR), Ruling, 18 September 2026** — High Court of Kenya at Nairobi (Milimani), Constitutional and Human Rights Division; text as reported by SheriaHub from Kenya Law, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court ruled on 18 September 2026 in Matey v Safaricom that Safaricom must, within 21 days, give a subscriber her subscriber details and records of every request for access to her communications, M-Pesa and transaction data, plus access logs, for March 2024 to January 2025. The court relied on the constitutional right of access to information, subject to the Data Protection Act.

DATA-PROTECTION CERTIFICATE AS A CONDITION OF DIGITAL-LENDER LICENSING

- **Stakeholders push for data sovereignty as AI conference tackles power shortages, worker exploitation** — Citizen Digital, 25 September 2026

  At the Africa AI Stakeholder Meeting in Nairobi, Kenya's deputy data commissioner John Walubengo said an agreement with the Central Bank of Kenya requires digital lenders to hold a data-protection compliance certificate before being licensed. A Schneider Electric speaker said Kenya has 0.6% of global data-centre capacity, with local facilities about 37% utilised.

DATA PROTECTION COMMISSIONER SUCCESSION

- **Kenya's Data Commissioner search comes as AI transforms data governance** — TechTrends KE, 30 September 2026

  Kenya's Public Service Commission shortlisted 13 of 152 applicants to succeed Immaculate Kassait as Data Protection Commissioner at the end of her single six-year term, with interviews on 5 October 2026.

DATA BREACH SUIT AGAINST ABSA BANK KENYA

- **How Absa Bank's employee data leak brought down multi-billion business** — The Standard, 12 October 2026

  A former senior manager at a Kenyan bank testified, in a Sh1.5 billion data breach suit against it, that a credit manager disclosed a borrower's loan distress to a third party. He said the bank's legal department recommended no action because it saw no material risk of abuse.

Regional collaboration

CONTINENTAL BEHAVIOURAL INTELLIGENCE AND INFODEMIC MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

- **Africa CDC Calls for Stronger Community Engagement and Behavioural Intelligence to Boost Health Security** — Ommy Dallah, 3 September 2026 AFRICA

  Africa CDC held a continental workshop in Mombasa to harmonise a common framework for behavioural intelligence and infodemic management in public health. Delegates from Kenya, Ghana, Zimbabwe, Burundi and Mauritania attended, and Africa CDC's senior regional representative urged countries to use available technology for health surveillance and communication. No cost or timetable for the framework is given.

- **Africa CDC advances public health intelligence framework** — The Star (Kenya), 4 September 2026 AFRICA

Africa CDC and member states validated components of a continental behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework at a five-day meeting in Mombasa, with participants from six countries alongside the ECOWAS regional surveillance centre and the WHO Africa Infodemic Response Alliance. The framework is to turn community feedback, social listening, service-delivery and programme data and rapid research into decision-ready intelligence; Africa CDC states it is not another database or reporting platform.

MALABO CONVENTION RATIFICATION POSITION

- **Invitation: High-Level Malabo Convention Dialogue – Monday, 7th September 2026** — Kenya ICT Action Network (KICTANet), 4 September 2026

  Kenya ICT Action Network invited members, on behalf of Mzalendo Trust, to a parliamentary breakfast dialogue in Nairobi on 7 September 2026 on Kenya's accession to the African Union's Malabo Convention. Members of the National Assembly's communication committee, the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner and civil society were to attend; seven places were offered to network members.

KENYA-ARMENIA DIGITAL COOPERATION TALKS

- **Kenya and Armenia Explore Digital Cooperation in AI, Cloud and Youth Skills** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Kenya and Armenia have opened discussions on cooperation in digital technologies, education, ICT, trade and investment, after a meeting between the ICT principal secretary and Armenia's ambassador. Artificial intelligence and cloud computing were identified as potential areas alongside youth skills; no instrument has been signed.

CROSS-BORDER DIGITAL PUBLIC SERVICE PILOT AMONG AFRICAN UNION STATES

- **UNGA81: Kenya proposes cross-border digital public service pilot for Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo proposed that willing African Union member states jointly pilot one cross-border public service and report back by February 2027. He made the proposal at an AUC-Google ministerial roundtable in New York, pointing to eCitizen's more than 22,500 services and Kenya's Government Interoperability Framework.

DIGITAL COOPERATION ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

- **Kenya Signs DCO Charter on the Sidelines of UNGA81** — African Eye Report (DCO announcement), 28 September 2026

  Kenya signed the Digital Cooperation Organization Charter on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New York, becoming a signatory member on the way to full accession. ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo Gitau signed for Kenya. The organisation says Kenya is one of eight approved candidates whose accession would raise membership from 16 to 24 countries. The signing date is not given.

Standards

NATIONAL INFORMATION SECURITY FRAMEWORK AUDIT AND RISK TOOLKITS

- **ICT Authority steps up protection of Govt systems, critical information infrastructure** — Education News (Kenya), 7 September 2026

Kenya's technology authority put the National Information Security Framework's audit, risk-management and certification mechanisms to a Nairobi stakeholder workshop, to establish whether they are practical for national implementation ahead of certifying critical information infrastructure. The framework text and the certification criteria are not published.

CENTRAL BANK GUIDANCE NOTE ON AI FOR THE BANKING SECTOR

- **Central Bank of Kenya - Bank Supervision Annual Report 2025** — Central Bank of Kenya, 22 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Kenya's Bank Supervision Annual Report 2025, published on 22 September 2026, reports a March 2025 survey in which 50% of supervised institutions had adopted artificial intelligence, including 66% of commercial banks, and 30% had formal AI strategies. Credit risk assessment was the commonest use. The bank plans an AI guidance note for the sector.

MEMBERSHIP OF THE INTERNATIONAL STANDARDS ORGANISATION

- **ISO - KEBS - Kenya Bureau of Standards** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

  ISO lists the Kenya Bureau of Standards (KEBS), set up under the Standards Act in 1974, as Kenya's member body. It holds one technical committee secretariat, participates in 129 committees and observes 177.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

CIVIL-SOCIETY POSITION ON DIGITAL TAXATION

- **Why Kenyan Creators Are Pushing Back on the YouTube Tax** — KICTANet, 2 September 2026

  Kenyan creators are contesting the withholding tax on video-platform earnings, which sits alongside the digital services tax, value-added tax on digital marketplace supply and the digital asset tax. The civil-society network carrying the campaign published its own brief on digital-tax reform in 2024.

LITIGATION OVER THE DIGITAL SUPERHIGHWAY TENDERS

- **Why High Court quashed Attorney General's opinion on Digital Superhighway tender** — Pulse Kenya, 4 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court on 4 September 2026 quashed a Solicitor-General's advisory of 1 October 2024 that cleared the Digital Superhighway tender awarded to Nightigale (EA) Limited of conflict-of-interest concerns. Justice Lawrence Mugambi ruled the question belonged to the Ethics and Anti-Corruption Commission and referred it there. The fibre project was put at more than Sh15 billion, funded from the Universal Service Fund.

- **High Court nullifies Attorney General's opinion on which Communications Authority relied upon to pay its former Chairperson Mary Wambui Mungai** — Consumers Federation of Kenya (COFEK), 4 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court quashed as unconstitutional the Attorney-General's advisory opinion of 1 October 2024 clearing a former Communications Authority chairperson of conflict of interest over two Digital Superhighway tenders awarded to Nightigale, according to the Consumers Federation of Kenya, which brought the case. The court did not void the contracts, and said the anti-corruption commission is the forum to investigate.

HERSPACE KENYA

- **HerSpace Kenya: A New Initiative to Confront Technology-Facilitated Gender-Based Violence** — KICTANet, 25 September 2026

> The Kenya ICT Action Network launched HerSpace Kenya, a two-year programme backed by Co-Impact against technology-facilitated gender-based violence. It will train police, prosecutors and judges to handle digital evidence, train women on reporting, and engage platforms on content moderation. A 2023 KICTANet study found 54% of women respondents had experienced such violence.

Finance

New investments

New investments

> KENYA DIGITAL ECONOMY ACCELERATION PROJECT

- **Kenya Accelerates Digital Economy Investments Under KDEAP** — Tukio, 14 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT principal secretary, John Tanui, and a World Bank delegation reviewed progress on the Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project, covering fibre, public Wi-Fi, digital government services and skills. Its Digital Smartboards Programme, run by the ICT Authority with the education ministry, has reached 10,384 public junior schools in all 47 counties and trained 62,364 teachers.

- **Kenya, World Bank Take Stock of Digital Economy Project KDEAP's Gains and Challenges** — Ecofin Agency, 15 September 2026

  Kenya and the World Bank reviewed the $390 million Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project on 14 September 2026; more than 62,000 teachers have been trained and over 5,000 smart boards distributed. A 2025 World Bank aide-memoire found only eight of 25 results indicators on target and $10.6 million disbursed, 3.1% of the appraised amount. The project closes on 31 October 2028.

> NATIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE FUND

- **MPs find gaps in the rules for the KES 340 billion fund built from the Safaricom sale** — Tech-ish, 14 September 2026

  Kenya's parliamentary finance committee, chaired by Kuria Kimani, recommended a near-total rewrite of the investment policy for the National Infrastructure Fund, reported on 14 September 2026. It found the policy silent on project risk, selection, borrowing and liquidity limits and exposure caps. The fund holds KES 340bn, mostly from the sale of the state's Safaricom stake, and ICT is one of its five sectors.

- **Sh320bn raised for National Infrastructure Fund, Ruto says** — The Star, 15 September 2026

  The president said about Sh320bn has been raised for the National Infrastructure Fund, which is now established in law with its top management appointed and its investment policy framework complete. The money is to finance roads, energy and water.

- **Vodacom's Safaricom deal struck down by Kenyan high court** — TechCentral, 15 September 2026
  SOUTH AFRICA

  Kenya's High Court on 15 September 2026 declared the government's sale of a 15 per cent Safaricom stake to Vodacom's Vodafone Kenya unconstitutional and ordered the shares returned to the state. The three-judge bench found public participation inadequate and the buyer's identity concealed. The June sale raised KSh204.3 billion; Vodacom said it will appeal and seek a stay.

> DIGIKEN LOAN PORTFOLIO GUARANTEE WITH A COMMERCIAL BANK

- **Co-op Bank, UNCDF launch financing facility to boost Kenya's digital** — Bizna Kenya, 24 September 2026

> Co-operative Bank of Kenya and UNCDF launched a US$900,000 loan portfolio guarantee under the DigiKen programme, backing up to US$1.8 million of lending to fintechs, digital credit providers, e-commerce and digitally enabled small firms, and innovation hubs. UNCDF covers 50% of outstanding principal, rising to 70% for borrowers in the Arid and Semi-Arid Lands.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity · Data Storage · Energy · Technical Capacity · Cybersecurity

Connectivity

BROADBAND SUBSCRIPTIONS REPORTED BY THE COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR

- **Ruto's 100,000km fibre optic network plan falters** — Daily Nation, 2 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo said 37,000km of the government's 100,000km fibre target has been laid, leaving 63,000km before the 2027 deadline. The network, funded through the Universal Service Fund, is meant to serve 53,000 government facilities; Kenya Power had been paid Sh940.6m by June 2025. Broadband subscriptions reached 52.85 million by March 2026.

- **Kenya's fixed internet market grows 32% as fibre expands** — TechTrendsKE, 19 September 2026

  Kenya had 2.84 million fixed internet subscriptions at 30 June 2026, up 32.4% in a year, according to Communications Authority statistics. Fibre rose 29.7% to 1.57 million, Starlink held 27,616 subscriptions, about 1% of the market, DSL fell to 23, and international bandwidth reached 28,950 Gbps.

DIGITAL SUPERHIGHWAY FIBRE AND HOTSPOT TARGETS

- **Ruto's 100,000km fibre optic network plan falters** — Daily Nation, 2 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Govt steps up Digital Superhighway implementation** — People Daily, 4 September 2026

  Kenya's principal secretaries for broadcasting and telecommunications, Stephen Isaboke, and for ICT and the digital economy, John Tanui, co-chaired a multi-agency meeting on 4 September 2026 to review the Digital Superhighway programme. The programme covers the national fibre network, last-mile connectivity, digital hubs and public Wi-Fi. No progress figures, costs or deadlines were given.

ALINET SOLAR-POWERED COMMUNITY NETWORK, SIPILI

- **Seeding change: A solar-powered community network shaping meaningful connectivity in Kenya** — Association for Progressive Communications (APC), 9 September 2026

  The Association for Progressive Communications reported on 9 September 2026 that the ALINET community network in Sipili, Kenya, run by the Arid Lands Information Network (ALIN East Africa), uses solar power as its main supply to withstand outages and voltage surges. ALIN obtained a licence for the network in 2023; Sipili's surrounding population is put at over 100,000, mostly farmers.

LULU COASTAL CABLE SYSTEM

- **Kenya coast gets first protected subsea cable, LuLu** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026

  A consortium unveiled the LuLu Coastal Cable System at ITW Africa 2026, presented as the first fully protected submarine cable dedicated to Kenya's Indian Ocean coastline: 500km linking five landing points from Mombasa to Lamu, including Vipingo Special Economic Zone, Kilifi and Malindi, pairing a seabed cable with a parallel protected terrestrial route. It is specified at 144 fibres and up to 60Tbps per fibre pair over a 25-year design life,

with service targeted for the second quarter of 2028 subject to contract execution, and the Mombasa landing connecting it to cables already landed at the port. The co-developers named are INDOI of Mauritius, Blue Trade Investments as the Kenya-registered landing party, ARISE IIP, AfriTrade Consulting Group and Kingdom Bank; no project value or financing structure is stated.

- **New submarine cable puts Kenya's Coast on digital growth path** — The Standard, 10 September 2026

  A planned submarine cable would link Mombasa to Lamu through five landing points along Kenya's coastline, with a parallel terrestrial route to keep services running if the seabed link is disrupted. The developers say it will extend resilient connectivity along 500 kilometres of coast and support data centres, cloud services and technology businesses; the consortium is anchored on the Vipingo special economic zone.

PARATUS GOMA-TO-MOMBASA TERRESTRIAL FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC RWANDA UGANDA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

AIRTEL KENYA TELESONIC WHOLESALE FIBRE SUBSIDIARY

- **Airtel Africa Shuts Down Kenya Fiber Unit After Two Years** — Techweez, 14 September 2026

  Airtel Africa is winding up Airtel Kenya Telesonic, its wholesale fibre subsidiary, two years after launch, with a KES 16.1 million loss and no revenue in 2025. Its facilities licence was returned to the Communications Authority in February, with gazettement pending.

FRAMEWORK AGREEMENTS FOR NATIONAL BACKBONE AND CROSS-BORDER LINKS

- **Request for Bids KE-ICTA-538567-NC-RFB — Framework Agreements for Extending National Backbone and Cross Border Links (Lot 1, Lot 2)** — ICT Authority (Kenya), 15 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Authority issued bidding documents on 15 September 2026 for three-year framework agreements to extend the national fibre backbone (Lot 1) and cross-border and metro links (Lot 2). The procurement falls under the Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project, financed by credits 7289-KE and 7290-KE, and bids are due on 29 October 2026. No contract value is given.

- **Kenya floats tender for national fibre backbone, cross-border links** — TechTrends Kenya, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's backbone tender will be scored 80% on technical factors and 20% on cost, with winning bidders required to disclose beneficial ownership. Public-sector fibre stood at 30,454km in 2026, up from 22,486km in 2022.

- **Kenya ICTA Opens Tender to Expand National Fibre and Cross-Border Connectivity** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Authority opened an international tender to extend the national fibre backbone and cross-border and metro links under the World Bank-backed digital economy project, which TechAfricaNews says is financed by US$390 million in World Bank credits.

- **Kenya opens fibre backbone tender** — ITWeb Africa, 16 September 2026

Kenya's ICT Authority tendered two framework agreements, national backbone links and cross-border and metro links, each for three years extendable by two. Treasury puts the public-sector fibre network at 30,454km against a 100,000km target before the 2027 election.

- **Kenya Allocates KSh 13 Billion to Expand Fibre Network by 27,000 Kilometres** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026

  Kenya will put KSh 13 billion into extending its national fibre backbone and cross-border links by at least 27,000 km, the ICT principal secretary told a pre-bid session. Gaps are to be allocated by reverse auction to draw matching private capital.

STARLINK KENYA FIXED BROADBAND

- **Kenya's fixed internet market grows 32% as fibre expands** — TechTrendsKE, 19 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

GUIDELINES FOR COMMERCIAL INTERNET TELEPHONY SERVICES

- **Kenya CA Moves to Finalise Guidelines for Commercial Internet Telephony Services** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's Communications Authority invited stakeholders to validate its draft guidelines for commercial internet telephony services, after reviewing responses to an earlier consultation. The guidelines set the technical and operational terms for rolling out such services.

SATELLITE FREQUENCY LICENSING FRAMEWORK, 2026

- **Stakeholder Consultation on the Satellite Frequency Licensing Framework** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 13 October 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya published a draft Satellite Frequency Licensing Framework for comment on 13 October 2026, with submissions due by 6 November. It covers spectrum authorisation for satellite services from gateways to user terminals, makes landing rights a prerequisite, and would require type approval of equipment and records of every terminal and its location.

Data Storage

NBO2 DATA CENTRE, NAIROBI CAMPUS

- **Digital Realty Strengthens Nairobi as East Africa Digital Gateway with New Data Center** — Digital Realty, 7 September 2026

  A second facility on the operator's Nairobi campus adds 6.4MW of capacity, opened alongside the retirement of the iColo brand in Kenya and Mozambique in favour of the parent's. The figure is critical IT load rather than delivered live load, and no occupancy or campus total is published.

- **Government welcomes digital investors** — The Standard, 7 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT principal secretary John Tanui told investors the government is working on policy to keep the country attractive, speaking at the launch of the NBO2 data centre in Nairobi, where Icolo rebranded as Digital Realty. The company's Africa managing director Marcel Louw said it runs more than 17 data centres in Africa, with over 200 megawatts of capacity going live.

- **Firm bolsters East Africa's tech hub with data centre** — The Standard, 8 September 2026

Digital Realty opened its Nairobi Two (NBO2) data centre in Karen, adding 6.4 MW to its Nairobi campus, which now has more than 14 MW of IT power over 34,000 square metres. NBO2 has six data halls. The launch also marked the rebranding of icolo to Digital Realty; the source's date for the event is inconsistent.

NOBUS NAIROBI AVAILABILITY ZONE

- **Nobus Opens Nairobi Availability Zone** — CIO Africa, 9 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Nobus Cloud Services, a Nigerian public cloud provider operated from Lagos, went live with a Nairobi availability zone designated Nobus-EA-AZ1, letting Kenyan organisations provision workloads locally. It opened alongside a programme offering free cloud credits and technical support to African startups and enterprises.

OFFSHORE ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE DATA CENTRE AT MOMBASA

- **Greek firm Amaco partners with US energy giant for Sh194bn Mombasa data centre** — Business Daily Africa, 10 September 2026

  A Greek energy group has partnered with a United States energy-equipment company to supply gas turbines for its proposed US$1.5 billion artificial-intelligence data centre at Mombasa. The turbines would sit in an unmotorised floating power barge feeding local or national grids, and the facility is intended to serve East African demand for computing infrastructure.

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES SOVEREIGN CLOUD AT IXAFRICA

- **TCS Sovereign Cloud Goes Live In Nairobi** — CIO Africa, 28 September 2026

  Tata Consultancy Services' sovereign cloud went live in Kenya, hosted at iXAfrica's Nairobi campus and delivered with a regional integrator, aimed at government agencies and regulated sectors with data-residency rules. Its capacity, pricing and clients were not disclosed.

Energy

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTE-ANCHORED MINI-GRID DEMONSTRATION

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026 DRC SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  The Rockefeller Foundation's Mission 300 Accelerator announced the Emergent Grid Project on 24 September 2026, testing whether AI computing placed at African mini-grids can act as an anchor customer and improve their finances. The first sites are five in Kenya, a solar plant in DR Congo and three in Sierra Leone, serving about 85,000 people, with local electricity demand given priority over computing. No amount is stated.

Technical Capacity

KENYA ADVANCED INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

- **Kenya, South Korea Deepen Ksh129.4B development partnership** — People Daily Digital, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's Treasury principal secretary, Chris Kiptoo, met Korea Eximbank in Seoul on 10 September 2026 to review the Ksh129.4 billion (US$1 billion) Economic Development Cooperation Fund framework. Projects discussed include the completed Ksh12.17 billion Kenya Advanced Institute of Science and Technology, the Intelligent Transport System and the recently approved Konza Digital Media City. No new amount or approval date is given.

Cybersecurity

CYBER THREAT EVENTS RECORDED BY THE COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR

- **Web attacks up 44pc as hackers target State, ISP systems** — Daily Nation, 3 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya reported a 43.7% rise in web application attacks in the quarter to June 2026, with government systems and internet service providers the main targets. Total cyber threat events fell 30% to 2.36 billion. The regulator advised organisations to disable SSL 3.0, replace end-of-life products and apply patches promptly.

GUIDE TO THE INVESTIGATION AND PROSECUTION OF CYBERCRIME

- **Investigation and Prosecution of Offences Under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act, Cap 79C: A Rapid Reference Guide** — National Computer and Cybercrimes Coordination Committee (NC4), with the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions and the National Police Service, Kenya, 3 September 2026

  Kenya's National Computer and Cybercrimes Coordination Committee, with the Director of Public Prosecutions and the National Police Service, launched a 140-page guide to investigating and prosecuting offences under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act on 3 September 2026. It covers 29 offences with 30 sample charges and seven court application templates, and omits sections 22 and 23, which the Court of Appeal declared unconstitutional.

- **Kenya unveils guide to standardise cybercrime investigation and prosecution** — The Star (Kenya), 3 September 2026

  Kenya launched a guide to investigating and prosecuting cybercrime under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act on 3 September 2026, listing 76 offences with sample cases. Internal Security Principal Secretary Raymond Omollo said it also covers cross-border cooperation and evidence preservation as Kenya pursues accession to the Budapest Convention. Cybercrime is put at about Sh29 billion a year.

NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY AGENCY

- **Safer cyberspace beckons as State firms up oversight agency** — The Star, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's National Cybersecurity Agency has a Director General in post but is not yet fully operational, according to a government implementation committee communiqué reported on 11 September 2026. Recruitment of technical and administrative staff and board appointments are still under way. Parliament received the memorandum for Legal Notice No. 89 of 2026, the order establishing the agency, in June.

- **CSs, CJ Koome Make New Appointments as Lorna Ogolla Joins NCA** — Kenyans.co.ke, 12 September 2026

  Kenya's interior cabinet secretary, Kipchumba Murkomen, appointed Lorna Ogolla Omondi and Jerop Joy Kibor to the board of the National Cybersecurity Agency for three-year terms, in a gazette notice dated 11 September 2026. The same round of notices named a chair and four members of the Kenya National Innovation Agency board.

- **Kenya Appoints Two Members To National Cybersecurity Agency Board** — CIO Africa, 14 September 2026

  Kenya's interior minister Kipchumba Murkomen appointed Lorna Omondi Ogolla and Joy Kibor to the board of the new National Cybersecurity Agency for three years, effective 11 September 2026 under Gazette Notice 14420. Ogolla leads Google Research's machine-learning and AI partnerships in Africa; Kibor heads postgraduate ICT studies at Zetech University.

NATIONAL COMPUTER INCIDENT RESPONSE CENTRE'S DIGITAL FORENSICS LABORATORY

- **Govt steps up safety against cybersecurity and data privacy** — The Standard, 7 October 2026

> Kenya's ICT minister told the Senate that the national incident response centre's digital forensics laboratory has received more than 200 investigation requests, most involving online abuse. A working group on online safety, a national referral directory and a review of gaps in the law have been agreed.

DPI

Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Data Exchange

REVENUE-AUTHORITY ENFORCEMENT OF A THIRD COUNTRY'S IMPORT E-PERMIT CHARGE

- **On The Spot: URA Links With US-Sanctioned South Sudan Firm Crawford Capital Raises Concern - The Capital Times** — The Capital Times, 1 September 2026 SOUTH SUDAN UGANDA

  The Capital Times reports that Uganda's and Kenya's revenue authorities still enforce e-Permit collections at border points for Crawford Capital, a firm the United States sanctioned on 12 May 2026 over diverting South Sudanese public funds. The UK-registered company collects a dollar charge on imports bound for South Sudan; documents cited show the Uganda Revenue Authority shares customs data with South Sudan's revenue authority but do not show a direct contract.

PESALINK AND PAPSS INTERLINK

- **ABC Bank Connects Customers to 190+ African Banks Through PAPSS Payment Network** — Soko Directory, 3 September 2026

  Kenya's ABC Bank went live on the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System on 3 September 2026, letting customers pay recipients at more than 190 banks in 28 countries. Payments can be sent in Kenyan shillings for receipt in local currency, or in US dollars between USD accounts. PAPSS was developed by Afreximbank with the AfCFTA Secretariat and links 16 payment switches.

- **PAPSS payments grew 1,000% in a year, and Kenya is now on the network** — tech-ish, 17 September 2026 AFRICA

  Payments across the pan-African settlement network are reported to have grown about tenfold over the year while the average payment fell to about a fifth of its level a year earlier — many small transfers in place of a few large ones. Kenya's national switch is the first of its kind piloted for termination on the network.

UNIFIED VERIFICATION OF PUBLIC SERVANTS' ACADEMIC CERTIFICATES

- **Government Plans Unified System to Verify Public Servants' Certificates - Nairobi Wire** — Nairobi Wire, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's head of public service convened the public service commission, the examinations council and the education ministry to build a single mechanism linking academic credential databases to hiring agencies, to cut verification delays and fake certificates. No design or date is set.

MASTERKEY DIGITAL SKILLS AND WORK WALLET

- **Kenyan President Ruto names Ghana among first countries for portable skills programme** — Graphic Online, 22 September 2026 GHANA RWANDA

Kenya's President William Ruto announced Masterkey, a digital wallet holding verifiable records of qualifications and work experience that individuals control and can share across African borders, at an Accra Reset event during the UN General Assembly. Ghana, Rwanda and Kenya are in the first phase, which targets 150,000 placements; Kenya's wallet runs through eCitizen.

SECOND KENYA SOCIAL ECONOMIC INCLUSION PROJECT

- **Govt Moves to Link SHA, NSSF With Social Protection Database** — Kenyans.co.ke, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's State Department for Social Protection is seeking a consultant to upgrade the Enhanced Single Registry and the Community Development Management Information System so they exchange data with the Social Health Authority, NSSF, the population register IPRS, civil registration and cash-transfer programmes, Kenyans.co.ke reported on 22 September 2026. The work falls under the World Bank-funded second Kenya Social and Economic Inclusion Project. No cost is given.

UNIFIED OPERATIONS PLATFORM LINKING GOVERNMENT SYSTEMS

- **Kenya Has 22,000 Digital Services but Still Face a Manual Backend** — Techweez, 23 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Principal Secretary Mary Kerema told WSO2Con Africa 2026 that the government runs more than 22,000 online services but its back-end processing is still largely manual, so citizens carry documents the state already holds. She said a Government Enterprise Architecture has been launched and an interoperability platform for sharing data between agencies is in development.

- **State plans unified platform to link government systems** — TechTrendsKE, 23 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT principal secretary John Tanui said, in a speech read for him at WSO2Con Africa in Nairobi on 23 September 2026, that the government is building an Enterprise Platform to link public institutions' systems through secure APIs before deploying AI agents in public services. He said Zero Trust security must be a founding principle for autonomous AI in government. No cost or timetable is given.

VOTER REGISTER VERIFICATION AGAINST THE CIVIL IDENTITY REGISTER

- **IEBC turns to ID data to meet voter targets** — Daily Nation, 8 October 2026

  Kenya's electoral commission IEBC is moving its voter registration targets from census estimates of the voting-age population to National Registration Bureau and immigration data on issued ID cards and passports, according to a parliamentary committee report adopted by the National Assembly. Its target of 6.3 million new voters for 2027 was set under the old census model.

Digital Identity and CRVS

REMOVAL OF EXTRA ID VETTING IN BORDER COUNTIES

- **600,000 secure IDs after government drops extra vetting in border counties** — Radio Generation Kenya, 17 September 2026

  Kenya's National Registration Bureau said more than 600,000 people who previously could not obtain identity cards have been registered since extra vetting in border counties was dropped after President William Ruto's announcement in Wajir on 5 February 2025. Bureau secretary Gilbert Kitiyo said registration continues and first-time applications and replacements are free.

- **End ID vetting for good, rights groups urge government** — The Star, 17 September 2026

Five Kenyan rights groups, including the Nubian Rights Forum and Haki na Sheria Initiative, urged the government to write the abolition of identity card vetting into law before the 2027 election, rather than relying on a presidential directive. They want discretionary review powers removed and free document verification for applicants who prove name, age and citizenship.

DIGITAL BIRTH-NOTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **Kenya's digital birth registration platform enrols 270k newborns in two months** — Biometric Update, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's electronic birth notification system, launched in June 2026, registered more than 270,000 newborns and gave them unique personal identifiers within two months. It sends birth details from hospitals to civil registration offices. Principal Secretary Belio Kipsang said 2.4 million national IDs were issued from January to September 2026, and an e-notification system for deaths is planned.

- **State to Expand Digital Birth Registration to SHA Hospitals Within 3 Months** — Kenyans.co.ke, 6 October 2026

  Kenya will extend electronic birth notification to every hospital contracted by the Social Health Authority within three months, by December 2026, the immigration principal secretary said. Newborns notified this way receive a Unique Personal Identifier, and talks with the health ministry on linking civil registration to hospital systems are complete.

- **Kenya to introduce electronic birth notifications in three counties from Mashujaa Day** — TechTrendsKE, 14 October 2026

  Kenya's Interior Cabinet Secretary, Kipchumba Murkomen, announced that electronic birth notification will be piloted in Nandi, Uasin Gishu and Elgeyo Marakwet counties from Mashujaa Day, 20 October 2026, sending birth records from health facilities straight to civil registration. The Immigration principal secretary said it will reach all hospitals covered by the Social Health Authority within three months.

DIGITAL LIVE CAPTURE DEVICES FOR IDENTITY ISSUANCE

- **Bungoma ID registration hampered by staff, vehicle and equipment shortages** — Vivid Voice News, 3 October 2026

  Kenya's National Assembly committee on administration and internal security inspected registration offices in Bungoma County on 2 October 2026 and heard that ID and civil registration are held back by shortages of staff, vehicles, equipment and office space. The county has two ageing vehicles. It recorded 19,361 registrations between July and September 2026.

- **Parliament probes delays in issuance of IDs, birth certificates in Elgeyo Marakwet** — People Daily, 5 October 2026

  Kenya's National Assembly committee on administration and internal security heard on 5 October 2026 that national ID cards in Elgeyo Marakwet County take one to two months to issue against a two-week standard. Officials blamed processing in Nairobi, poor connectivity, too few staff and vehicles, and some sub-counties receiving as little as Sh10,000 for fuel a quarter.

Digital Payments and Fintech

KENYAN BANK PARTICIPATION IN PAPSS

- **ABC Bank goes live on intra-African pay system** — Business Today Kenya, 7 September 2026 AFRICA

Kenya's African Banking Corporation (ABC Bank) has gone live on the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, letting customers send and receive payments across 28 African countries. Customers can pay accounts at more than 190 participating banks, sending either in Kenyan shillings or in the recipient's currency.

- **PAPSS goes live at I&M Bank Kenya to expand cross-border payments** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System went live for customers of I&M Bank Kenya, the second Kenyan bank on the network. Customers can send to participating African markets in Kenyan shillings through the bank's branches rather than converting into an international currency; no volume, fee or corridor detail was published.

ACCESS TO CROSS-BORDER CONSUMER PAYMENT PLATFORMS

- **The platforms that help Kenyans get paid are changing the rules** — TechCabal, 8 September 2026

  The cross-border routes Kenyans use to be paid narrowed one by one over the past year: an international payments provider restricted accounts, a dollar-banking service closed, a remittance wallet paused and a streaming platform ended creator monetisation.

MERCHANT PAYMENT-INTEGRATION TOOL

- **Kenya : Kopo Kopo lance une nouvelle solution pour simplifier les paiements** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  A Kenyan technology company has launched an updated payment-integration tool letting businesses embed settlement options directly in their own software, merchant sites and mobile applications. It says more than 40,000 merchants can now automate refunds, send grouped payments and process transactions faster.

MOBILE MONEY MARKET SHARE

- **Fourth Quarter Sector Statistics Report for the Financial Year 2025/2026 (1st April - 30th June 2026)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 17 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya's statistics report for April to June 2026 puts mobile subscriptions at 88.0 million and mobile money subscriptions at 54.0 million on 30 June 2026, up 13.2% over the year. Registered mobile money agents numbered 568,463, down from 602,470 the previous quarter. The report carries no publication date on its face.

- **Airtel's virtual card will test Safaricom's grip on Kenya's online payments** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Airtel Money plans to launch a Mastercard prepaid virtual card linked to its wallets in Kenya, competing with Safaricom's M-PESA GlobalPay. Communications Authority figures put M-PESA's mobile money share at 88.8% and Airtel Money's at 11.1% in June 2026; Airtel has issued more than 875,000 virtual cards in Uganda, Zambia and Tanzania since 2025.

MOBILE MONEY SUBSCRIPTIONS AND AGENTS

- **Fourth Quarter Sector Statistics Report for the Financial Year 2025/2026 (1st April - 30th June 2026)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 17 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **Kenya Mobile Money Accounts Hit 54 Million Even as More Than 34,000 Agents Exit the Market** — Dawan Africa, 18 September 2026

Kenya's regulator put mobile money subscriptions at 54,005,800 at the end of June 2026, up 1.2 per cent in the quarter and 13.2 per cent on the year, while more than 34,000 registered agents left the market in the same three months. Subscriptions count accounts, not people.

CBK NATIONAL SWITCH AND FAST PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Draft National Payment System Policy, August 2026** — The National Treasury, Republic of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

KCB GROUP ACQUISITION OF A STAKE IN PESAPAL

- **Tanzania regulator reveals KCB's 22.23% stake in payments firm Pesapal** — TechCabal, 22 September 2026

  TANZANIA

  Tanzania's Fair Competition Commission put KCB Group's stake in Kenyan payments firm Pesapal at 22.23%, the first public figure for a deal KCB announced in 2025 without terms. The stake gives KCB indirect control of Pesapal Tanzania and is under the commission's review; its value is undisclosed.

KENSWITCH DOMESTIC CARD SCHEME

- **Kenswitch enters Kenya's card market with domestic card scheme** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026

  Kenswitch, Kenya's largest independent payments switch, launched a domestic card scheme on 22 September that lets banks and other institutions issue physical and virtual cards on its network of more than 2,200 ATMs, 50,000 point-of-sale terminals and 80,000 agent outlets. It named no issuers, launch dates or pricing against Visa and Mastercard.

REGISTERED MOBILE-MONEY ACCOUNTS AND AGENTS

- **The Next Wave: Kenya’s payments revolution cannot end with mobile money** — TechCabal, 27 September 2026

  A commentary argues that Kenya's success with mobile money has left the rest of its payments system neglected, citing central bank figures of 94.35 million registered accounts and KES 728.7 billion moved in July 2026. It calls for attention to bank rails, cards and cross-border payments beyond the dominant wallet.

DIGITAL CREDIT PROVIDER LICENSING

- **Kenya licenses 29 new digital lenders** — ITWeb Africa, 30 September 2026

  Trade-press report of the Central Bank of Kenya's licensing of 29 more digital lenders, summarised under the bank's own press release.

- **Press Release: Licensing of Digital Credit Providers** — Central Bank of Kenya, 30 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Kenya licensed 29 more digital credit providers, bringing the total to 281, from more than 900 applications since March 2022. Licensed lenders had made 9,596,509 loans worth Ksh165.1 billion by August 2026.

M-PESA TAP-TO-PAY AND QR ON PESAPAL TERMINALS

- **Safaricom taps Pesapal’s 30,000 POS terminals to take M-PESA contactless** — TechCabal, 1 October 2026

  Safaricom and Pesapal put M-PESA tap-to-pay and QR payment on Pesapal's 30,000 point-of-sale terminals in Kenya, with no extra fee. Safaricom says scan-to-pay is live at more than 60,000 merchant outlets and targets 500,000 within a year.

EMMA WALLET (FINSERVE AFRICA)

- **The strategy behind Equity Bank's new digital wallet** — TechCabal, 6 October 2026

  Equity Bank's fintech arm, Finserve Africa, has launched a wallet called EMMA, reached by Android application, short code or the Equitel SIM toolkit and opened with an identity document and a facial check. Users can send money to M-PESA merchants, Airtel Money and bank accounts; the analysis reads it as the bank's bid to keep everyday payments, and the data behind them, on its own platform.

PESALINK ID ACCOUNT ALIAS

- **PesaLink's New ID Makes Bank Transfers Easier. The Bigger Question Is Who Owns the Rail.** — Fintech Association of Kenya (LinkedIn), 8 October 2026

  Kenya's bank-owned instant payment switch says a portable identifier is ready, so a sender need not know the recipient's bank, and institutions must now map customers to it. A fintech association asks who will own the rail as the alias takes hold.

AIRTEL MONEY VIRTUAL CARD

- **Airtel's virtual card will test Safaricom's grip on Kenya's online payments** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

M-PESA GLOBALPAY VIRTUAL CARD

- **Airtel's virtual card will test Safaricom's grip on Kenya's online payments** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Registries

NATIONAL ADDRESSING SYSTEM FOR KENYA (NASK)

- **Kenya and Lesotho Deepen ICT Regulatory Cooperation on National Addressing System** — Tech Africa News, 2 September 2026 LESOTHO

  Kenya's Communications Authority is hosting a Lesotho Communications Authority delegation to benchmark Kenya's National Addressing System and the legal framework behind it. Kenya's system is designed to give every street, building and parcel of land a verifiable address, supporting last-mile e-commerce delivery and emergency response, and the authority has driven the draft National Addressing System Bill, 2025 with standards developed jointly with the Kenya Bureau of Standards. No visit dates are stated.

ARDHISASA LAND PLATFORM

- **LSK demands urgent restoration of Ardhisasa platform amid land transaction delays** — The Eastleigh Voice, 3 September 2026

  The Law Society of Kenya said in a statement of 2 September 2026 that the Ardhisasa land administration platform had been unavailable since 1 September, halting searches, transfers and registrations. It asked the State Department for Lands to explain the outage, give a restoration timeline and ensure users face no penalties. No cause or timetable had been announced.

- **Concern as Govt Land Platform Goes Down, Kenyans Face Service Disruption** — Kenyans.co.ke, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's ArdhiSasa land platform announced an outage on 21 September 2026 affecting searches, transfers, title and lease registration, and stamp duty and land-rent payments, with no time given for restoring service. The Law Society of Kenya had already complained that the platform was unavailable from 1 September.

Sectoral management information systems

TRACK AND TRACE SYSTEM FOR THE HEALTH-PRODUCTS SUPPLY CHAIN

- **Kenya Steps Up Preparations for Extraordinary African Manufacturing Summit** — Ministry of Health (Kenya), 1 September 2026

  Kenya's Principal Secretary for Medical Services met Africa CDC and African Union Commission officials on 1 September to prepare the Extraordinary Summit on African Manufacturing, set for 3–5 December 2026 in Nairobi. He cited work to digitise the health-products supply chain through the Track and Trace system. No cost or timetable for the system is given.

SOCIAL HEALTH AUTHORITY CLAIMS PLATFORM

- **National and County Governments Strengthen Coordination on Health Reforms** — Ministry of Health, Kenya, 3 September 2026

  Kenya's health ministry and county governments reported at an intergovernmental council session on 31 August 2026 that the Social Health Authority has settled 78% of claims across the 47 counties, paying KSh 159.3 billion. The council also reviewed moving 7,789 health workers to permanent terms, with KSh 8.6 billion allocated, after problems transferring them to county payrolls.

KENYA EDUCATION MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **The NEMIS to KEMIS Dilemma: How Kenya's School Data Overhaul Is Colliding With Grade 10 Selection** — Techweez, 9 September 2026

  Kenya's switch from the NEMIS school data system to KEMIS ran into failed logins, lost submissions and outdated learner records during the 2026 Grade 10 selection for nearly 1.2 million pupils, Techweez reported on 9 September 2026. Education PS John Ololtuaa told MPs in late August that the latest capitation payment used neither system but manually verified data.

- **Education data systems switch leaves schools with millions in funding gaps** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026

  Kenya's Auditor-General found that the NEMIS learner database, replaced by KEMIS in September 2025, under-counted pupils in national schools and left them underfunded. A parliamentary committee resolved to summon the Education Cabinet Secretary.

SOCIAL HEALTH AUTHORITY CENTRALISED PROVIDER ONBOARDING

- **SHA Sets Out Requirements for Healthcare Providers Seeking New Contracts** — Tukio, 14 September 2026

  Kenya's Social Health Authority set out requirements for providers in its contracting cycle running from 1 October 2026 to 30 June 2029 across four funds, Tukio reported on 14 September 2026. Facilities must onboard through a Centralised Digital Platform, have a working electronic medical records or approved claims system, submit claims electronically and pass know-your-customer and financial checks.

- **SHA launches e-contracting portal for healthcare providers as new applications open** — People Daily, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's Social Health Authority put its E-Contracting Portal live at 3pm on 17 September 2026 for health providers seeking contracts under four health funds. Chief executive Mercy Mwangangi said earlier applications were tests and would be archived, so every provider must apply again.

- **Kenya Ministry of Health unveils E-contracting Platform in Nairobi** — HealthCare Middle East & Africa, 20 September 2026

Kenya's health cabinet secretary, Aden Duale, launched the Social Health Authority's 2026-2029 contracting cycle, HAKIKA, and an e-contracting platform at KICC in Nairobi. Providers will submit applications, upload compliance documents, verify licences and sign contracts online; the contracts set claims-processing timelines and downtime safeguards. Providers were urged to transfer before 1 October 2026.

- **Social Health Authority (Kenya) - HAKIKA Healthcare Provider Contract Pack, 2026-2029 contracting cycle (revised, Parts A, B1, B2, B3)** — Social Health Authority (Kenya), 28 September 2026

  Kenya's Social Health Authority published its revised HAKIKA contract pack for healthcare providers on 28 September 2026, covering the 2026–2029 contracting cycle. The primary healthcare contract requires providers to record every visit on SHA's Centralized Digital Platform in real time, run a health information system certified by the Digital Health Agency, and submit claims electronically within seven days of service. The general terms (Part A) are a scan without text.

- **Duale and Governors Set 14 October Deadline for SHA Facility Contracts** — Kenya Ministry of Health, 5 October 2026

  Kenya's health ministry and the Council of Governors' health committee agreed that current Social Health Authority facility contracts will not be extended again, and that the authority will run HAKIKA contracting clinics in every county until 14 October 2026. Facilities meeting other requirements get 30 days to submit outstanding documents, including data protection compliance.

MIGRATION OF CONTRACTED HEALTH FACILITIES FROM THE INSURER'S PROVIDER PORTAL TO THE HEALTH MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Duale orders health facilities to switch to SHA digital system by September 30** — The Star (Kenya), 29 September 2026

  Kenya's Health Cabinet Secretary, Aden Duale, ordered all facilities contracted by the Social Health Authority to move to the new Health Management Information System by 30 September 2026, when the old provider portal closes. Public hospitals at levels two to four have moved, and 530 of 876 faith-based facilities are transacting on the system.

- **Duale grants one month extension for SHA – HMIS transition** — Kenya Broadcasting Corporation, 1 October 2026

  Kenya's Health Cabinet Secretary Aden Duale extended to 30 October 2026 the deadline for public Level 5 and 6, faith-based and private facilities to move from the Social Health Authority provider portal to hospital management information systems, KBC reported on 1 October 2026. Of 518 contracted faith-based facilities, 38 have moved; the Digital Health Agency will support the rest, and no patient is to be refused care meanwhile.

- **Why SHA is shifting hospitals from portal to HMIS, Duale explains** — The Standard, 2 October 2026

  Kenya's Health Cabinet Secretary Aden Duale said hospitals are being moved from the Social Health Authority provider portal to their own management information systems because running both created duplicate work and longer waits, The Standard reported on 2 October 2026. All 6,427 public Level 2 to 4 facilities have moved, four of the Level 5 hospitals have migrated, and the Digital Health Agency has certified 28 private systems; the deadline is 30 October.

- **New SHA payment system: Why hospitals have a problem with Duale's plan** — Daily Nation, 3 October 2026

Kenya's health secretary, Aden Duale, met private hospital owners on 2 October 2026 over the forced move from the Savannah Informatics-run Social Health Authority claims portal to certified hospital information systems bought from accredited vendors. Owners put the cost at up to Sh1 million a year; the ministry extended the deadline to 30 October and agreed a facility-by-facility transition plan.

- **CS Duale Calls for Timely Transition to HMIS and SHA Contracting** — Kenya Ministry of Health, 6 October 2026

  Kenya's health cabinet secretary urged providers to meet the timelines for moving from the insurer's provider portal to the health management information system and for completing the 2026-2029 contracting cycle. The ministry puts migration at 6,427 public facilities, 38 certified private facilities and 38 of 518 faith-based ones, and says correctly submitted claims will still be paid during the change.

DCI BIOMETRIC IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM FOR POLICE CLEARANCE (MBIS)

- **DCI rolls out biometric clearance to diplomats** — The Standard, 14 October 2026

  Kenya's Directorate of Criminal Investigations extended its biometric police clearance certificate service to diplomats. The MBIS system behind it, launched on 23 July, linked 26 of 63 application centres by September; the DCI says processing has fallen from 14 days to same-day.

ALL DISEASE OUTBREAK MODULE (ADAM)

- **Disabling of Ebola reporting tool cripples alertness** — The Standard, 15 October 2026

  Kenya's health ministry switched off AdaM, its real-time module for reporting suspected Ebola and other notifiable-disease cases, in the middle of its Ebola response. Responders said they had not been told about a replacement, which an insider named as UHAI.

MURANG'A COUNTY AFYAKE MEDICAL RECORDS SYSTEM

- **Kang'ata accuses State of putting lives at risk with AfyaKE shutdown** — The Standard, 15 October 2026

  Murang'a's governor accused Kenya's national government of switching off the county's AfyaKE digital health system to force it onto another platform, leaving patient records from 2023 inaccessible and services scaled down. Claims the county had uploaded to the Social Health Authority are reported missing. See the health ministry's denial under the same heading.

- **MoH denies tampering with Murang'a County's health portal** — Citizen Digital, 15 October 2026

  Kenya's Ministry of Health denied switching off Murang'a County's AfyaKE electronic medical records system. The health cabinet secretary called the system a private arrangement between the county and its developers and said neither had sought certification from the Digital Health Agency; the county says it has run in 165 facilities since 2023.

- **AfyaKE system shutdown: 65,000 patient records at centre of Kang'ata-Duale showdown** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026

  Murang'a Governor Irungu Kang'ata accuses Kenya's national government of switching off the county's AfyaKE hospital system ahead of the 30 October deadline to move to the national Tibabu system, leaving records for about 65,000 patients out of reach and stalling SHA claims. He says the system raised health revenue from Sh80 million to Sh800 million a year; the Ministry of Health says neither the county nor the developers applied for certification.

- **Murang'a County sues State over patient, hospital system shutdown** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026

Murang'a County has petitioned Kenya's High Court against the Ministry of Health, the Digital Health Agency, the Health Cabinet Secretary, SHA and the Attorney-General after losing access to its Afya.KE health information system on 14 October 2026. It seeks orders restoring access and protecting clinical records across its more than 176 health facilities while the petition is heard.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ITAX

- **MONARI: When iTax fails, the taxpayer still pays** — The Star, 1 September 2026

  A column on Kenya's tax portal failing on the evening of the 30 June filing deadline, when the revenue authority itself notified a traffic surge and intermittent delays. The penalties for late filing continued to run.

UNRECONCILED GAP IN THE SERVICE PLATFORM'S REPORTED COLLECTIONS

- **eCitizen under scrutiny over Sh36.5bn collections gap** — Radio Generation Kenya, 2 September 2026

  Kiambu gubernatorial aspirant Bonnie Mwangi called on 2 September 2026 for Parliament to investigate Kenya's eCitizen payment platform, citing Auditor-General findings for 2023/24. Reported collections were about Sh100.84 billion but bank statements supported only Sh64.30 billion, a gap of Sh36.5 billion, and four transfers worth Sh127.85 million went from the government paybill to private entities without supporting approvals.

INTEGRATED ELECTIONS MANAGEMENT SYSTEM PROCUREMENT

- **2027 elections technology: IEBC ordered to review tender rules** — Daily Nation, 4 September 2026

  Kenya's Public Procurement Administrative Review Board ordered the electoral commission, IEBC, to correct and re-issue its tender for 2027 election technology, reported on 4 September 2026, finding that it did not disclose how technical scores would be awarded. The board told IEBC to seek advice from the procurement regulator and give bidders at least seven days, and rejected a claim that the specifications favoured Miru Systems.

- **PPARB Application No. 192 of 2026: Leading Edge Limited v Accounting Officer, IEBC & IEBC — Tender No. IEBC/OIT/001A/2026-2027, Integrated Elections Management System (IEMS)** — Public Procurement Administrative Review Board (Kenya), 14 October 2026

  Kenya's procurement review board dismissed Leading Edge Limited's challenge to the electoral commission's tender for an Integrated Elections Management System. It ordered the commission to proceed and the applicant to pay KSh 2 million in costs.

- **IEBC cleared to proceed with Sh6.5bn election technology tender** — Daily Nation, 15 October 2026

  Kenya's procurement review board cleared the electoral commission to continue its KSh 6.5 billion tender for election technology for 2027. The board upheld the tender's device and turnover thresholds and rejected a bidder's challenge.

GOVERNMENT VEHICLE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **West African Governments Are Finally Tracking Their Own Vehicles** — Liberian Observer, 8 September 2026

  LIBERIA

A named analyst's column in the Liberian Observer contrasts Kenya's Government Vehicle Management System, announced on 6 August 2026 by head of public service Felix Koskei to track every state vehicle's driver, fuel, mileage and maintenance, with Liberia's handover of 56 untracked vehicles and motorbikes to agriculture officers.

CITIZEN ADOPTION OF AND SATISFACTION WITH DIGITAL GOVERNMENT SERVICES

- **Kenyans among world's heaviest AI users, survey shows** — TechTrends Media Ltd, 10 September 2026

  Boston Consulting Group's eighth biennial Digital Government Citizen Survey found 87% of Kenyan respondents use AI at least weekly, against a global average of 64%. Kenya's adoption of digital government services is 49%, net satisfaction fell five points since 2024 to 64%, and only 12% of users reported no problems, the lowest share of any market surveyed.

MULTI-VENDOR ELECTRONIC SEALS UNDER THE REGIONAL CARGO TRACKING SYSTEM

- **Approved vendors for the electronic monitoring and tracking of goods under customs control and transition to the multi-vendor user-owned framework** — Kenya Revenue Authority, 11 September 2026

  The Kenya Revenue Authority has approved 15 vendors to provide electronic tracking of goods under customs control, moving the Regional Electronic Cargo Tracking System to a multi-vendor, user-owned model for dry-cargo and fuel seals. KRA-owned seals will be phased out by 26 October 2026. The notice does not list the vendors.

- **KRA's unveils new system to boost cargo security and risk management** — The Standard, 15 September 2026

  The Kenya Revenue Authority is replacing its government-owned electronic cargo seal system with a multi-vendor framework from 26 October 2026, under the Regional Electronic Cargo Monitoring System. Importers, exporters, agents and transporters will choose among 15 approved private vendors for dry cargo and fuel seals; the authority says this brings GPS tracking and geofencing.

- **Traders support revenue agency's multi-vendor cargo tracking system** — The Star (Kenya), 16 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  Importers, exporters and logistics firms welcomed the Kenya Revenue Authority's decision to open the regional electronic cargo tracking system to private seal vendors. The Shippers Council of Eastern Africa expects competition to end seal shortages that have delayed transit cargo at Mombasa.

ONLINE DRIVING-LICENCE RENEWAL AND APPLICATION SERVICE

- **NTSA Clarifies System Hitch Affecting Driving Licenses** — Kenyans.co.ke, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's National Transport and Safety Authority said on 11 September 2026 that a fault on its side was blocking online driving-licence renewals and first-time applications, which showed a blank page. It gave no date for a fix. The outage came a day after the authority began a nationwide document-compliance crackdown with the police.

DIGIKEN PROGRAMME

- **Kenya's DigiKen Programme Mobilises $4.26 Million for Digital Transformation** — Tech Africa News, 15 September 2026

  A multi-stakeholder digital programme carrying about US$4.26m in funding and co-financing supports fifteen innovation hubs in media and information literacy, digital skills, platform entrepreneurship and sustainable agriculture. Its steering committee reviewed progress.

HUDUMA CENTRES

- **Mwea residents get government services closer home with new Huduma Centre** — Kenya Broadcasting Corporation, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's Deputy President, Kithure Kindiki, commissioned the Mwea Huduma Centre at Ngurubani on 18 September 2026; it has operated since July. It is Kenya's 61st Huduma Centre and offers identity documents, birth and death certificates and Kenya Revenue Authority services under one roof, with a Jitume ICT hub for youth digital skills.

- **Huduma Centres face legal test after 12 years without framework** — Daily Nation, 15 October 2026

  Kenya's Auditor-General found that the secretariat running the Huduma Centres has worked since 2014 without the policy and legal framework its founding notice requires, so the legality of its operations could not be confirmed. The Public Service principal secretary told MPs a draft framework is with the Cabinet Secretary.

PARTY AND OBSERVER ACCESS TO THE VOTER REGISTRATION SYSTEM'S SOURCE CODE AND AUDIT LOGS

- **Political parties, election observers to access IEBC voter register** — The Standard, 20 September 2026

  Kenyan political parties and election observers are to be given access to the source code and audit logs of the electoral commission's continuous voter registration system, following a court directive. The account is a free lede behind a paywall and names neither the court, the case nor the date of the directive.

KENYA DIASPORA IMPACT PLATFORM

- **Kenya, UN and Equity Sign Joint Declaration of Intent for the Kenya Diaspora Impact Platform Initiative** — State Department for Diaspora Affairs, Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's government, the United Nations in Kenya and Equity Group Holdings signed a joint declaration of intent in New York on 20 September 2026 to work on the Kenya Diaspora Impact Platform, a digital gateway linking diaspora investors to verified investment and development projects in Kenya. No budget, operator or launch date is given.

SERVICES AVAILABLE THROUGH ECITIZEN

- **Kenya Has 22,000 Digital Services but Still Face a Manual Backend** — Techweez, 23 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

- **UNGA81: Kenya proposes cross-border digital public service pilot for Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

ELECTRONIC TRAVEL AUTHORISATION (ETA) SYSTEM

- **Mohammed & another v Ministry of Interior and National Administration & 4 others (Constitutional Petition E006 of 2026) [2026] KEHC 15080 (KLR) (5 October 2026) (Judgment)** — High Court of Kenya at Marsabit (Kenya Law), 5 October 2026

  Kenya's High Court at Marsabit on 5 October 2026 dismissed a constitutional petition against mandatory travel health insurance for foreign visitors under Gazette Notice No. 11492 of 30 July 2026. The court held the notice valid and found the petitioners' claim that insurance data collected through the Electronic Travel Authorisation system was insecure to be general and unproven. No costs were awarded.

INSTANT FINES TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Senate seeks clarity on traffic cameras and NTSA's automated fines** — Radio Generation, 9 October 2026

  Kenya's Senate ICT committee questioned National Transport and Safety Authority director general Nashon Kondiwa on 8 October 2026 about the Instant Fines Traffic Management System, including its legal basis and how offences are detected, notified and paid. The High Court halted automated penalties under the system on 12 March 2026, three days after its announcement, and the authority withdrew its launch notice on 27 March.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government · Rural digital data capture

Digitalisation of sub-national government

NAKURU COUNTY GENDER-BASED VIOLENCE AND DISABILITY CASE MANAGEMENT PLATFORM

- **New Digital Platform Launched in Nakuru County to Improve Support for Survivors of Gender-Based Violence and Persons with Disabilities** — County Government of Nakuru, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's Nakuru County government announced on 22 September 2026 a digital case-management platform for gender-based violence cases and disability services, funded by Lithuania's development cooperation fund and built by Lithuanian firm Erobotai with the Vilnius Chamber of Commerce. So far 54 GBV cases and 216 disability-service applications have been registered. No cost is given.

COUNTY PAYROLL MIGRATION TO THE HUMAN RESOURCE INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Revealed: Counties made Sh8.3bn manual payments outside payroll systems** — Daily Nation, 1 October 2026

  Kenya's Controller of Budget reported that county governments paid at least Sh8.3 billion in salaries through manual payrolls outside the Human Resource Information System in the year to 30 June 2026, despite a directive to migrate by June 2025. Nakuru County paid Sh1.86 billion, 21.8% of its personnel costs, manually; Wajir, Nairobi, Siaya and Mandera also had high shares.

MOMBASA COUNTY CAMERA-BASED INSTANT TRAFFIC FINES

- **Mombasa tuk-tuk fines: Who is watching the watchers?** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026

  Two Mombasa tuk-tuk associations went to the High Court against the county's camera-based instant traffic fines, which block operators' stickers on the county portal until they are paid. They argue that no published law authorises the system or its capture of passengers' images; the case returns on 9 November.

Rural digital data capture

MKULIMA BORA AGRICULTURAL MARKETPLACE

- **From GovStack Principles to Practice: Connecting Kenyan Farmers with Markets through Mkulima Bora** — GovStack, 8 September 2026

  Kenya is piloting a digital agricultural marketplace across five Rift Valley counties, built on reusable components and open standards, with identity-verified onboarding and more than a thousand users.

Technology

AI · ICT Industry · Innovation ecosystem

AI

KENYA ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE BILL 2026

- **Report of the Standing Committee on Information, Communication and Technology on the Artificial Intelligence Bill, 2026 (Senate Bills No. 4 of 2026)** — Parliament of Kenya — The Senate, Standing Committee on Information, Communication and Technology, 1 September 2026

  The Kenyan Senate's ICT committee report on the Artificial Intelligence Bill, 2026 (Senate Bills No. 4 of 2026) recommends that the Senate does not proceed with the Bill. The 170-page report draws on written submissions from 143 stakeholders and asks for a national AI policy to be published first.

- **Senate committee shoots down Nyamu's Bill on AI, warns of Sh5 million fines** — The Star (Kenya), 15 October 2026

  Kenya's Senate ICT committee has asked the Senate not to proceed with Senator Karen Nyamu's Artificial Intelligence Bill, 2026, after hearing from 143 stakeholders. It objected to fines of up to KSh 5 million and up to two years' imprisonment, and to an AI Commissioner whose powers would overlap existing regulators, and called for a national AI policy first.

AI-GENERATED POLITICAL INFLUENCE OPERATION AHEAD OF THE 2027 ELECTION

- **'What matters is evidence!' Wandayi distances himself from AI campaign praising tariff move** — The Star, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's Energy Cabinet Secretary Opiyo Wandayi said on 11 September 2026 that his ministry neither authorised nor took part in an AI-generated social media campaign praising its withdrawal of a Kenya Power tariff rise. A report found an unnamed actor used the Claude chatbot to produce batches of 50 posts under #PowerReliefKE, and found no evidence of government involvement.

- **Anthropic flags Kenya AI influence operation** — ITWeb Africa, 11 September 2026

  Anthropic's September 2026 report on misuse of its AI models, covering December 2025 to August 2026, says a domestic Kenyan actor used Claude to mass-produce political posts made to look like grassroots opinion ahead of the 2027 election. Many praised energy secretary James Opiyo Wandayi. Anthropic found no evidence of government involvement and said the content did not reach genuine users.

- **CS Wandayi Responds to Anthropic Report on AI-Generated Campaign Praising Him** — Kenyans.co.ke, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's energy cabinet secretary, Opiyo Wandayi, said on 11 September 2026 that an Anthropic threat-intelligence report did not show that he or his ministry took part in an AI-generated social media campaign praising him over electricity tariffs. The report described one actor using Claude to produce Kenyan political posts in batches of 50 and found no evidence of government involvement.

- **Kenyan political operator used Claude to mass-produce election propaganda, Anthropic says** — TechCabal, 11 September 2026

  Anthropic said it removed an account that used Claude to produce Kenyan political posts in batches of 50 ahead of the 2027 election, TechCabal reported on 11 September 2026. The posts praised energy cabinet secretary Opiyo Wandayi and attacked opposition figures; Anthropic found no evidence of government involvement and no sign the content reached real people.

KONZA DIGITAL MEDIA CITY AND AI DATA CENTRE

- **Kenya, South Korea Deepen Ksh129.4B development partnership** — People Daily Digital, 11 September 2026

  Summarised under Technical Capacity.

NATIONAL AI COMPUTING PLATFORM

- **Kenya, UNDP move to operationalise sovereign AI infrastructure at Konza Data Centre** — TechReview Africa, 11 September 2026

  The UN Development Programme in Kenya and the Technopolis Development Authority signed a letter of agreement to put sovereign AI infrastructure into operation at the Konza Data Centre, TechReview Africa reported on 11 September 2026. The infrastructure is to support the AI Accelerator programme, green technology and applied research. No cost, capacity or timetable is given.

BANK USE OF AI IN CREDIT RISK ASSESSMENT

- **AI already decides who gets a loan in Kenya. Now decide who governs it** — Capital FM Kenya, 14 September 2026

  In an opinion piece ahead of the National Credit Market Convention in Naivasha, Kevin Mutiso writes that Kenya's 256 licensed digital credit providers have disbursed 8.37 million loans worth over KES 150bn using scoring models. He proposes rules modelled on the EU AI Act, whose credit-scoring provisions took effect on 2 August 2026, but graded by how opaque and autonomous each system is.

- **Central Bank of Kenya - Bank Supervision Annual Report 2025** — Central Bank of Kenya, 22 September 2026

  Summarised under Standards.

OPENSCOPES AIDDIA AI MICROSCOPY PROGRAMME

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA | UGANDA | CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

ROADMAP FOR CHILDREN'S RIGHTS AND PROTECTION IN THE AGE OF AI, 2026-2027

- **Ruto Calls for Safer AI and Technology for Children** — ynews.digital, 23 September 2026

  Kenya's President William Ruto called for technology that is safe by design for children at a UN meeting of the Coalition for Children's Rights and Protection in the Age of AI, which Kenya launched with France and Spain in July. The coalition unveiled a 2026-2027 roadmap backed by 23 states and eight UN entities. Ruto said Kenya is drafting an AI and emerging technologies policy expected to cover child online safety.

- **UNGA81: Kenya joins global leaders to promote children's rights in the Age of AI** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  President Ruto co-hosted the launch of a 2026-2027 Roadmap for Children's Rights and Protection in the Age of AI at the UN General Assembly, alongside the leaders of France, Spain and Australia. Kenya's technology envoy Philip Thigo said Kenya would take the work forward at home, across Africa and globally.

DHOLUO SPEECH DATASET

- **MCAAI drives Dholuo speech data collection to improve AI representation** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

The Maseno Centre for Applied Artificial Intelligence ran a preparatory visit to Suba ahead of collecting Dholuo speech data to improve the language's representation in AI systems, onboarding participants to its SmartVoice app. The work involves the ACTS-AI4D team.

HUB FOR AI AND DISABILITY INCLUSION AND AFRICAN DISABILITY DATA NETWORK

- **How Africa's AI boom is leaving 100 million disabled citizens behind** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026 GHANA AFRICA

  A Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI), hosted by KNUST's Responsible AI Lab, and an African Disability Data Network were launched at the Global Data Festival in Nairobi with backing from IDRC, the UK FCDO and AI4D. They plan to map disability-related datasets, build three new datasets, assess how national AI strategies treat disability and fund three startups with grants of up to KES 5 million.

MORAN AI CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE

- **Kenya and Cisco deepen partnership on AI skills, cybersecurity and digital transformation** — Tech Review Africa, 28 September 2026

  Kenya's President and technology envoy discussed with Cisco the Moran AI Centre of Excellence, being developed with the defence forces as a regional hub for AI and cybersecurity, alongside AI skills for young people.

NATIONAL ASSEMBLY INQUIRY INTO AI IN EDUCATION, HEALTH AND THE PUBLIC SECTOR

- **AI in classrooms and hospitals: MPs launch probe, seek new rules** — Daily Nation, 18 October 2026

  Kenya's National Assembly gave its communication committee one month to report on how AI is used in education, health and the public sector, and on the rules that govern it. MPs said there is no national AI framework and are weighing a standalone AI law.

ICT Industry

FIBRE OPERATOR REPOSITIONING INTO AI AND CLOUD SERVICES

- **Interview: Liquid bets on AI as next growth frontier for Africa's fibre network** — TechTrends KE, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  The same operator is repositioning from connectivity provider to a layered artificial intelligence, cloud and cybersecurity business on top of its fibre backbone, its vice-president and chief executive said at a Nairobi conference. Connectivity becomes the foundation of digital infrastructure rather than the product, he argued, naming data-centre capacity as the concern African telecom executives raise most.

- **Interview: Liquid targets Africa's data centre gap** — ITWeb Africa, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  A pan-African fibre operator's Kenyan chief executive says the continent's data-centre capacity is becoming a major concern for African telecom executives, as the business pushes deeper into artificial intelligence and cloud services. He puts Africa at 0.6 per cent of the world's data-centre capacity.

GOVERNMENT SALE OF A 15% STAKE IN THE LARGEST TELCO

- **Kenya’s High Court voids Vodacom’s $1.5 billion Safaricom takeover** — TechCabal, 15 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  A three-judge High Court bench voided the government's sale of a 15 per cent Safaricom stake, a KES 204.3bn transaction that closed less than three months earlier, ruling it unconstitutional because key information was withheld from the public, the cabinet and parliament.

- **Vodacom's Safaricom deal struck down by Kenyan high court** — TechCentral, 15 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under New investments.

- **Safaricom ruling crucial** — Daily Nation, 16 September 2026

  The Daily Nation's editorial welcomes the Kenyan High Court ruling that annulled the government's Sh204.3 billion sale of its 15% Safaricom stake to Vodacom Group as unconstitutional. The court found inadequate public participation, concealment of material information and bypassed regulatory review, and ordered the 6 billion shares returned to state ownership.

- **Vodacom, Kenya to appeal court ruling voiding Safaricom sale** — Connecting Africa, 16 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA

  Vodacom and Kenya's Treasury both said on 16 September 2026 that they will appeal the High Court ruling that voided the sale of a 15% government stake in Safaricom. The court found the deal lacked meaningful public participation and hid material information, and ordered the stake returned to the state.

M-KOPA ACQUISITION OF A DEVICE-LOCKING SOFTWARE COMPANY

- **M-KOPA acquires Finnish device-locking company KilpiTek Oy for $8 million** — TechCabal, 7 October 2026

  M-KOPA's financial statements show it completed the US$8m acquisition of a Finnish device-locking software company on 26 March 2026, US$2.67m of it in cash. The purchase brings in-house the technology that restricts financed smartphones when customers fall behind.

MICROSOFT AFRICA DEVELOPMENT CENTRE, NAIROBI

- **Microsoft to shut Nairobi engineering centre, putting hundreds of jobs at risk** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026

  Microsoft is winding down its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi, staff were told on 12 October, putting nearly 400 jobs at risk with fewer than 10 expected to remain. The company confirmed only proposed changes to its engineering operations; Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary, briefed the same day, agreed a joint action plan with it.

- **Microsoft's Nairobi Development Centre Faces Possible Closure** — Kenyans.co.ke, 13 October 2026

  Microsoft plans to close the engineering department of its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi after more than seven years, a Kenyan outlet reports. Between 400 and 500 employees could be affected.

Innovation ecosystem

WORKKE ONLINE WORK PLATFORM

- **Avec WorkKE, le Kényan Kennedy Mokaya démocratise le travail en ligne en Afrique** — wearetech.africa, 8 September 2026

  WorkKE, a Kenyan platform launched in 2024, matches businesses to freelancers and uses local cybercafes as access relays, releasing escrow-held payments as project stages are validated and settling over mobile money. It reports more than 1,650 registered users, over 500 of them freelancers, and 200 partner cybercafes, and is extending into Uganda, Tanzania, Nigeria, South Africa and Ghana; the counts are the company's own.

Capacity

Literacy · Training and skills · Research institutions

Literacy

DIGITAL LITERACY PROGRAMME

- **Kenya : 1000 diplômés en TIC recrutés pour soutenir la numérisation des écoles** — wearetech.africa, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's Public Service Commission opened applications on 15 September 2026 for 1,000 ICT graduates to spend 12 months in schools and sub-county education offices supporting the Digital Literacy Programme. Applications close on 5 October 2026.

- **Kenya Begins Digital Literacy Programme Phase II Device Rollout in Nairobi** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Kenya began the second phase of its Digital Literacy Programme, putting teacher laptops and interactive smartboards into 10,382 public junior schools. In Nairobi all 98 targeted schools had devices and 91 had completed installation and acceptance.

- **Kenya Deploys Smart Boards to 178 Public Junior Schools in Nyeri** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Kenya began delivering smart boards and teacher laptops to 178 public junior schools in Nyeri County on 21 September, under phase II of the Digital Literacy Programme. The programme is funded through the World Bank-supported Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project and is to reach all 377 junior schools in the county.

- **Kenya ICT Authority Expands Digital Learning Rollout to 377 Junior Schools in Nyeri** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  The ICT Authority's account of the same Nyeri rollout adds that more than 62,000 teachers nationally have already been trained under the Digital Literacy Programme.

AI FOR CITIZENS PROGRAMME (PUBLIC LIBRARIES)

- **Kenya and Intel Partner to Expand AI Literacy Through Public Libraries** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's State Department of ICT signed a partnership with Intel at the UN General Assembly to teach AI literacy through public libraries. It will run through the Kenya National Library Service and the Mandela AI Hub Foundation under Intel's AI for Citizens programme.

Training and skills

RESPONSIBLE AI USE IN COMPETENCY-BASED STEM TEACHING

- **CEMASTEA champions responsible AI use in competency-based STEM education** — Kenya News Agency, 4 September 2026

  Kenya's Centre for Mathematics, Science and Technology Education in Africa (CEMASTEA) held a two-day workshop in Nairobi on 3–4 September 2026 on digital literacy for competency-based STEM teaching, attended by about 100 teachers, lecturers and specialists. Acting chief executive Gladys Masai warned that over-reliance on AI could weaken learners' independent thinking.

SHECONNECTS EMPOWERHER DIGITAL ACCELERATOR

- **KICTANet SheConnects EmpowerHer Digital Accelerator — Tana River Trainer of Trainers** — KICTANet, 9 September 2026

Kenya's ICT policy network KICTANet held a three-day workshop in Tana River County from 9 to 11 September 2026 to train 100 women as trainers in its digital skills curriculum for women micro-entrepreneurs. Under its EmpowerHer project, 300 such trainers in Nairobi, Tana River and Nyandarua counties are to reach 15,000 women.

KFW DIGITALISATION OF VOCATIONAL TRAINING

- **D4TVET Tender 2026 - Prequalification of Implementation Consultant** — Tenderyetu, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's State Department for Technical, Vocational Education and Training opened international prequalification for a five-year implementation consultant on its Digitalization for TVET project, listed on 22 September 2026. KfW, AFD and the EU co-finance the project with loans and grants totalling some EUR 50m. No date is given for the financing agreements.

DATA CENTRE ACADEMY FOR ENGINEERING GRADUATES

- **IBTC Expands Data Centre Academy to Kenya with Schneider Support** — Startup Kenya, 23 September 2026

  IBTC launched its Data Centre Academy in Kenya at ITW & Datacloud Africa in Nairobi, with iXAfrica Data Centres and IMEX as delivery partners and Schneider Electric University providing the curriculum. The first cohort is five iXAfrica technical staff on a three-week placement. The Kenya programme is supported by the EU-co-funded Digital Investment Facility; no funding amount is given.

JITUME DIGITAL ENABLEMENT PROGRAMME

- **Kenya Commissions Jitume ICT Hub in Uasin Gishu as Digital Network Reaches 391 Sites** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026

  Kenya commissioned a Jitume ICT hub at a technical training campus in Uasin Gishu, taking the national network to 391 equipped sites and 23,387 devices. Of 253 technical and vocational institutions, 186 have the equipment and 67 still wait.

KENYA SCHOOL OF GOVERNMENT ELEARNING AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY INSTITUTE (ELITI)

- **Kenya Launches KSG Digital Institute as 1,239 Public Officers Graduate in AI Training** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026

  The Kenya School of Government launched an eLearning and Information Technology Institute as 1,239 public officers graduated from a UNESCO-Oxford programme on artificial intelligence and digital transformation in government.

Research institutions

RESEARCH ON ALTERNATIVE MEDIA AND ELECTION MISINFORMATION

- **Kenya Alternative Media Report Warns Of Election Misinformation** — KICTANet, 9 September 2026

  The Kenya ICT Action Network launched a report, Many Microphones, Little Accountability, at a webinar on 9 September 2026, finding that Facebook, TikTok, YouTube and X are reshaping political news and spreading misinformation ahead of the 2027 general election. The study drew on three months of platform monitoring, a national survey and interviews.

CIVIL-SOCIETY SUBMISSIONS ON ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTRUMENTS

- **CIPESA Weighs in on Kenya's Draft Guidance Notes on AI and Emerging Technologies** — CIPESA, 24 September 2026

> CIPESA submitted comments on draft guidance notes on AI and on emerging technologies issued for consultation by Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner. It warns that requiring adequacy assessments for cross-border transfers could lead to blanket data localisation. It also asks for impact assessments on biometric processing, audits of feed algorithms and oversight of state use.

Inclusion

Access to services · Digital divides

Access to services

> CHILDREN EXPOSED TO UNWANTED SEXUAL CONTENT ONLINE

- **When the danger comes through a child's phone: One in five children exposed to sexual content online** — Daily Nation, 5 September 2026

  A UNICEF report finds about one million internet-using Kenyan children aged 12–17, 20.1%, have been exposed to unwanted sexual content online, the third-highest rate of 21 countries surveyed. Most victims knew their abusers, WhatsApp was the platform most used, and about 1% of cases are reported to police.

> DIGITAL LEARNING INITIATIVE IN PUBLIC JUNIOR SCHOOLS

- **Kenya Expands Digital Learning Initiative to 10,384 Public Junior Schools** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Kenya is extending its digital learning initiative to 10,384 public junior schools, distributing smartboards and laptops, digitising curriculum content and training teachers. It is run by the ICT ministry through its authority, with the education ministry, the curriculum development institute and the teachers' service commission.

Digital divides

> PAY-AS-YOU-GO SMARTPHONE FINANCING MARKET

- **Sun King joins Kenya's growing smartphone financing race** — TechCabal, 4 September 2026

  Sun King began selling financed smartphones in Kenya, entering the market M-KOPA and Watu built. Its handset is sold only on a pay-as-you-go contract - a KES 2,299 deposit and KES 55 a day for 365 days, KES 22,374 in all - repaid through the phone's own lock screen, app, SIM toolkit or USSD, with the device locked if payments stop. The company opened a Tatu City assembly plant with capacity for 700,000 units a year in October 2025.

> DIGITAL SKILLS PROGRAMME FOR REFUGEE AND HOST-COMMUNITY YOUTH, GARISSA AND TURKANA

- **Garissa Refugee Youth Get Digital Skills Training** — CIO Africa, 11 September 2026

  Power Learn Project, the ILO, Microsoft and Garissa County Government marked the Garissa rollout of a 25-week digital skills and employment programme for refugee and host-community youth, funded by the Netherlands under the PROSPECTS Partnership. It targets 1,700 young people in Garissa and Turkana; over 700 have enrolled in Garissa, and Microsoft is providing up to 1,000 certification vouchers.

- **Kenya: 1,700 Youth in Garissa, Turkana to Get Digital Skills Training** — Capital FM (Nairobi), via allAfrica.com, 11 September 2026

  About 1,700 young people from refugee and host communities in Kenya's Garissa and Turkana counties are to receive 25 weeks of training in AI, cloud computing and data analytics. Power Learn Project runs it with the ILO, Microsoft and Garissa County, funded by the Netherlands; over 700 have enrolled in Garissa and 16 of 37 hubs have begun. No funding sum is given.

- **Power Learn Project Trains 1,700 Youth in Kenya AI, Cloud Skills** — TechMoran, 11 September 2026

  Power Learn Project is training 1,700 young people from refugee and host communities in Kenya's Garissa and Turkana counties in AI, cloud computing and data analytics over 25 weeks. Backed by the ILO, Microsoft and Garissa County and funded by the Netherlands, it has enrolled more than 700 learners in Garissa; women make up 35% of applicants. No funding amount is given.

Data

National statistics

National statistics

NATIONAL SURVEY ON CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION AND SAFETY

- **Kenya Reviews National Survey Findings on Child Online Protection and Safety** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya and the University of Nairobi's Institute for Development Studies have begun reviewing preliminary findings from a joint national survey on children's online experiences and safety, agreeing the report structure and thematic areas ahead of validation. The authority says the findings are intended as the evidence base for regulatory interventions on child online protection; nothing has been published yet.

INCLUSIVE DATA CHARTER ACTION PLAN 2026-2030

- **Kenya's second IDC Action Plan expands the country's commitments to inclusive data** — Global Partnership for Sustainable Development Data, 8 October 2026

  Kenya drafted its second Inclusive Data Charter action plan, for 2026 to 2030, at a workshop on 5 to 7 October. It widens the first plan's focus on disability to gender, children and older persons.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

US / hyperscaler activities

MEMORANDUM WITH THE HOOVER INSTITUTION'S EMERGING MARKETS WORKING GROUP

- **Kenya, Hoover Institution sign AI data pact** — ITWeb Africa, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's foreign ministry signed a five-year memorandum of understanding with the Emerging Markets Working Group at Stanford's Hoover Institution during the UN General Assembly in New York. The signing date was not given. The first project is an El Niño monitoring and response system that brings climate, geospatial, water, farming and infrastructure data together by county. Later work is to include a digital trade readiness index and a tracker for public-private partnerships.

JOINT DECLARATION WITH ANTHROPIC

- **Kenya signs AI deal with Claude AI to boost public-sector skills** — The Standard, 23 September 2026

  Kenya signed a Joint Declaration with Anthropic in New York during UNGA 81, covering AI applications in education and health, research, capacity building, and AI safety and evaluation. The next step is to develop specific pilots and institutional partnerships with government agencies.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-18-2**
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COVERAGE	Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.
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